

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

2000-02-20

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

we are deeply grieved at the passing of mildred mottahedeh, so esteemed, so greatly loved, so staunch and trusted a supporter and defender of the cause of bahá'u'lláh. with her departure from this earthly life the bahá'í world community has lost an outstanding figure of the opening epochs of the formative Age of the bahá'í dispensation.

her more than half a century of tireless endeavor in its service involved

her in teaching and administrative activities at the local, national, continental and international levels. At the same time she maintained a rigorous schedule as a businesswoman, a contributor to the arts, and a promoter of

humanitarian works. To these manifold tasks, she brought the combined

resources of a selfless spirit, a compassionate heart, a creative mind, a practical sense, and a leonine will tempered by humility, candor and wit.^{322.1}

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706She remained for almost three decades at the forefront of the external affairs work of the bahá'í international community and in the service of the world center of the faith, culminating in her membership on the international bahá'í council, the first globally elected bahá'í body.

with assured hearts, we supplicate in the holy Shrines for the progress of her illumined soul throughout the divine worlds. our loving sympathy is extended to the members of her family and all others who mourn her loss.

National Spiritual Assemblies are urged to hold befitting memorial gatherings in her honor in all houses of worship and other centers.

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Clarification on Application of Bahá'í Laws

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]